

Bangkok Shambhala

Services Configuration

Guide

Step-by-step setup for all external services

Version 1.0 — March 2026

Overview & Checklist

This guide walks you through configuring every external service the Bangkok Shambhala website depends on. Complete them in order — some services depend on others.

Master Checklist:

#	Service	Priority	Est. Time	Status
1	GitHub Repository	Required	5 min	☐
2	Vercel (Hosting)	Required	15 min	☐
3	Custom Domain & DNS	Required	15 min	☐
4	Brevo (Email / Newsletter)	Required	20 min	☐
5	Plausible Analytics	Required	10 min	☐
6	Admin Panel (Custom)	Required	10 min	☐
7	Google Search Console	Required	10 min	☐
8	Google Business Profile	Required	15 min	☐
9	Social Channels (WhatsApp, LINE)	Required	20 min	☐
10	Wise (International Donations)	Recommended	15 min	☐
11	PromptPay / Thai QR	Recommended	10 min	☐
12	n8n (Automation)	Recommended	30 min	☐
13	OpenAI API (Social Copy AI)	Optional	10 min	☐
14	Google Sheets (Social Copy Log)	Optional	10 min	☐
15	Cloudinary (Image CDN)	Optional	10 min	☐

Total estimated time: ~3–4 hours

1. GitHub Repository

Purpose: Source code hosting, version control, content storage.

You need: A GitHub account.

Steps

1. **Sign in** to github.com
2. **Repository already created** at: `https://github.com/braisntext/shambhalaBangkok`
3. **Add collaborators** (other admins/developers):
 - Go to repository → **Settings** → **Collaborators**
 - Click **Add people**
 - Enter their GitHub username or email
 - Assign role: `Write` for editors, `Admin` for administrators
4. **Protect main branch** (recommended):
 - Settings → **Branches** → **Add rule**
 - Branch name pattern: `main`
 - Enable: **Require a pull request before merging**
 - Enable: **Require status checks to pass** (select the CI workflow)
 - Click **Create**

Verification

- ☐ Repository accessible at `https://github.com/braisntext/shambhalaBangkok`
- ☐ CI workflow runs on push (check Actions tab)
- ☐ Collaborators can access the repo

2. Vercel (Hosting & Deployment)

Purpose: Website hosting, automatic builds, CDN, serverless API routes.

You need: GitHub account (same as above).

Steps

1. **Sign up** at vercel.com — use **Continue with GitHub**

2. **Import project:**

- Click **Add New → Project**
- Select the `braisntext/shambhalaBangkok` repository
- Vercel auto-detects Next.js

3. **Configure build settings:**

Setting	Value
Framework Preset	Next.js (auto-detected)
Root Directory	<code>shambala-bangkok</code>
Build Command	<code>pnpm build</code>
Output Directory	<code>.next</code>
Install Command	<code>pnpm install</code>
Node.js Version	20.x

4. **Set environment variables** (Settings → Environment Variables):

Variable	Value	Environments
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL	https://shambhala-bangkok.org	All
NEXT_PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN	shambhala-bangkok.org	All
BREVO_API_KEY	(from Step 4)	Production
BREVO_LIST_ID	(from Step 4)	Production
ADMIN_EMAIL	(from Step 6)	All
ADMIN_PASSWORD	(from Step 6)	All
ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET	(from Step 6)	All
GITHUB_TOKEN	(from Step 6)	All
TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY	(from Step 6, optional)	All
TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY	(from Step 6, optional)	All

Note: Don't worry about Brevo or Admin Panel values yet — come back after completing Sections 4 and 6.

5. Deploy:

- Click **Deploy**
- Wait for the build to complete (~1-2 minutes)
- Vercel assigns a temporary URL: shambhalabangkok.vercel.app

6. Verify the deployment:

- Open the temporary URL
- Check homepage loads
- Check /events , /blog , /about pages

Verification

- ☐ Vercel project created and linked to GitHub repo

- ☐ Automatic deployment on push to `main`
- ☐ Site loads at Vercel temporary URL
- ☐ Environment variables set

3. Custom Domain & DNS

Purpose: Point `shambhala-bangkok.org` to the Vercel deployment.

You need: Access to your domain registrar (where you bought the domain).

Steps

1. In Vercel:

- Go to Project → **Settings** → **Domains**
- Add domain: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
- Add domain: `www.shambhala-bangkok.org`
- Vercel shows the required DNS records

2. In your domain registrar (e.g., Namecheap, GoDaddy, Cloudflare):

Add these DNS records:

Type	Name	Value	TTL
A	@	<code>76.76.21.21</code>	300
CNAME	www	<code>cname.vercel-dns.com</code>	300

3. Wait for DNS propagation (5 min to 48 hours, usually <30 min)

4. Verify in Vercel:

- Go back to Settings → Domains
- Both domains should show a green checkmark ✓
- SSL certificate is issued automatically

5. Set redirect:

- Configure `www.shambhala-bangkok.org` to redirect to `shambhala-bangkok.org`

- In Vercel: Domains → www → set as "Redirect to" the apex domain

Verification

- ☐ `https://shambhala-bangkok.org` loads the site
 - ☐ `https://www.shambhala-bangkok.org` redirects to the apex
 - ☐ SSL padlock icon shows in browser
 - ☐ `http://` automatically redirects to `https://`
-

4. Brevo (Email & Newsletter)

Purpose: Newsletter subscription management, email sending for automations.

You need: A valid email address.

Step 4.1 — Create Account

1. Go to app.brevo.com/account/register
2. Sign up with email
3. Confirm your email address
4. Complete the onboarding wizard:
 - Company: `Bangkok Shambhala`
 - Industry: `Non-profit / Education`
 - Team size: `1-10`

Step 4.2 — Get API Key

1. Go to **Settings** (gear icon) → **SMTP & API** → **API Keys**
2. Click **Generate a new API key**
3. Name: `shambhala-bangkok-website`
4. Copy the API key

Important: Save this key securely. You won't see it again.

5. Add to Vercel:

- Go to Vercel → Project Settings → Environment Variables
- Add `BREVO_API_KEY` = *(paste the key)*
- Environment: Production

Step 4.3 — Create Contact List

1. Go to **Contacts** → **Lists**
2. Click **Create a list**
3. Name: `Newsletter Subscribers`
4. Note the **List ID** (shown in the URL or list details, usually `1` for the first list)
5. **Add to Vercel:**
 - Add `BREVO_LIST_ID` = *(the list ID number)*

Step 4.4 — Configure Sender

1. Go to **Settings** → **Senders & IP** → **Senders**
2. Click **Add a sender**
3. Fill in:
 - Name: `Bangkok Shambhala`
 - Email: `bangkok@shambhala.info` *(or your email)*
4. Brevo sends a verification email — click the link to confirm

Step 4.5 — Set Up Domain Authentication (Important for Deliverability)

1. Go to **Settings** → **Senders & IP** → **Domains**
2. Click **Add a domain**
3. Enter your domain: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
4. Brevo shows **3 DNS records** to add:

Type	Name	Value	Purpose
TXT	mail._domainkey.shambhala-bangkok.org	(provided by Brevo)	DKIM
TXT	shambhala-bangkok.org	(provided by Brevo)	SPF
CNAME	(provided)	(provided)	Tracking

5. Add these records in your DNS registrar
6. Back in Brevo, click **Verify**
7. Wait for validation (can take up to 24 hours)

Step 4.6 — Test the Newsletter Signup

1. Redeploy the site in Vercel (or wait for next push)
2. Open the website
3. Scroll to the footer newsletter form
4. Enter a test email address
5. Click Subscribe
6. Check Brevo → Contacts → the test email should appear in the list

Verification

- ☐ Brevo account created and confirmed
- ☐ API key generated and added to Vercel env vars
- ☐ Contact list created, List ID saved in Vercel
- ☐ Sender email verified
- ☐ Domain authenticated (DKIM + SPF)
- ☐ Test newsletter signup works end-to-end

5. Plausible Analytics

Purpose: Privacy-first website analytics — no cookies, GDPR/PDPA compliant.

You need: An email address. Plausible has a paid plan (~€9/month) or you can self-host for free.

Option A: Plausible Cloud (Recommended)

1. Sign up at plausible.io/register
2. Start the 30-day free trial
3. **Add your site:**
 - Click **Add a website**
 - Domain: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
4. **Snippet is already installed** — the site includes the Plausible script in `layout.tsx`
5. Verify in Vercel that `NEXT_PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN` is set to `shambhala-bangkok.org`

Option B: Self-hosted Plausible

1. Follow the [self-hosting guide](#)
2. Deploy on a VPS (e.g., DigitalOcean, Hetzner)
3. Update the script source in `src/app/layout.tsx` :

```
src="https://your-plausible-server.com/js/script.js"
```

Configure Goals (Optional but Recommended)

In your Plausible dashboard:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Goals**
2. Create these custom events:

Goal Name	Tracks
Newsletter Signup	Email subscriptions
Calendar Download	ICS file downloads
WhatsApp Join	Click on WhatsApp button
LINE Join	Click on LINE button
Donate Click	Click on donation methods
Event View	Views of event detail pages

Verification

- ☐ Plausible account created and site added
- ☐ Env variable `NEXT_PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN` set in Vercel
- ☐ Visit the site, then check Plausible dashboard — your visit should appear within 30 seconds
- ☐ Goals configured (optional)

6. Admin Panel (Custom Content Editor)

Purpose: Built-in web-based admin panel for managing events and blog posts.

You need: The deployed site + a GitHub Personal Access Token.

Step 6.1 — Generate a GitHub Personal Access Token

The admin panel uses the GitHub API to save content files to the repository.

- Go to github.com/settings/tokens?type=beta
- Click **Generate new token (Fine-grained)**
- Configure:
 - Token name: `bangkok-shambhala-admin`
 - Expiration: 90 days (set a calendar reminder to rotate)
 - Repository access: **Only select repositories** → `braisntext/shambhalaBangkok`

- Permissions → Repository permissions:

- **Contents:** Read and write

4. Click **Generate token**

5. Copy the token immediately

Step 6.2 — Generate a Session Secret

The admin panel uses HMAC-SHA256 signed cookies for authentication. You need a random secret:

```
openssl rand -hex 32
```

Copy the output.

Step 6.3 — Set Environment Variables in Vercel

Go to Vercel → Project Settings → Environment Variables and add:

Variable	Value	Required
ADMIN_EMAIL	shambalabangkok@gmail.com (your admin email)	✓ Yes
ADMIN_PASSWORD	(your chosen password)	✓ Yes
ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET	(from Step 6.2)	✓ Yes
GITHUB_TOKEN	(from Step 6.1)	✓ Yes
TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY	(from Cloudflare dashboard)	Optional
TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY	(from Cloudflare dashboard)	Optional

Security: Use a strong, unique password. The session secret must be at least 32 characters.

Step 6.4 — Optional: Enable Cloudflare Turnstile (Captcha)

To add bot protection on the login page:

1. Go to dash.cloudflare.com → **Turnstile**
2. Click **Add Site**
3. Site name: `Bangkok Shambhala`
4. Domain: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
5. Widget type: **Managed** (recommended)
6. Copy **Site Key** and **Secret Key**
7. Add both to Vercel env vars (see table above)

If these keys are not set, the login page works without captcha.

Step 6.5 — Test the Admin Panel

1. Navigate to `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/admin/login`
2. Enter your admin email and password
3. Complete the captcha (if enabled)
4. Click **Sign In**
5. Try creating a test event:
 - Click **Events** → **+ New Event**
 - Fill in the fields
 - Click **Save Event**
6. Wait 1-2 minutes for Vercel to rebuild
7. Check the event appears on the website

How It Works

- **Authentication:** Email/password checked against env vars → HMAC-SHA256 signed session cookie (24h expiry)
- **Content saving:** Admin panel → API route → GitHub API → commits Markdown file to repo → Vercel auto-rebuilds
- **No external CMS:** Everything runs within the Next.js application

Verification

- ☐ Admin panel accessible at `/admin/login`
 - ☐ Login works with configured email/password
 - ☐ Can create, edit, and save events
 - ☐ Can create, edit, and save blog posts
 - ☐ Saved content appears on site after rebuild (~1-2 min)
 - ☐ Turnstile captcha works (if configured)
-

7. Google Search Console

Purpose: Monitor search performance, submit sitemap, catch crawl errors.

You need: A Google account.

Steps

1. Go to search.google.com/search-console
2. Click **Add property**
3. Choose **Domain** property type
4. Enter: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
5. **Verify ownership** via DNS:
 - Google gives you a TXT record
 - Add it to your DNS:

Type	Name	Value
TXT	@	<code>google-site-verification=xxxxx</code>

6. Wait for verification (minutes to hours)

7. **Submit sitemap:**

- Go to **Sitemaps** in the left menu

- Enter: <https://shambhala-bangkok.org/sitemap.xml>
- Click **Submit**

8. **Request indexing** for key pages:

- Use the URL inspection tool at the top
- Enter your homepage URL
- Click **Request Indexing**
- Repeat for [/events](#) , [/blog](#) , [/learn/meditation](#) , [/community](#)

Verification

- ☐ Property verified in Search Console
 - ☐ Sitemap submitted and status shows "Success"
 - ☐ No crawl errors in the Coverage report
-

8. Google Business Profile

Purpose: Appear in Google Maps, local search results, "meditation bangkok" searches.

You need: A Google account, physical address access.

Steps

1. Go to business.google.com
2. Click **Manage now** or **Add your business**
3. Fill in business information:

Field	Value
Business name	Bangkok Shambhala Meditation Centre
Category	Meditation Centre
Address	Young Place Building, 3rd Floor, Sukhumvit Soi 23, Bangkok 10110
Phone	<i>(your community phone)</i>
Website	https://shambhala-bangkok.org

4. **Verify your business** — Google sends a postcard to the physical address with a verification code (takes 1-2 weeks), or offers phone/email verification for some accounts

5. **After verification, complete your profile:**

- Add business hours (meditation schedule):
 - Wednesday: 19:00 – 20:30
 - Sunday: 10:00 – 11:30
- Upload photos of the meditation space
- Write a business description:

"Bangkok Shambhala is a non-profit meditation community offering free weekly meditation sessions, workshops, and retreats in the Asok area of Bangkok. All experience levels welcome."

- Add attributes: Free Wi-Fi, Wheelchair accessible (if applicable)

6. **Link to your site** — ensure the website URL is correct

Verification

- ☐ Business profile created
- ☐ Ownership verified (postcard/phone/email)
- ☐ Hours, photos, description, and website URL added
- ☐ Profile appears in Google Maps search

9. Social Channels

Purpose: Community communication and event distribution.

9.1 WhatsApp Group

1. Open WhatsApp → **New Group**
2. Name: `Bangkok Shambhala Community`
3. Set group description with website link
4. Go to **Group settings** → **Invite via link**
5. Copy the invite link
6. **Update** `src/lib/config.ts` — replace the placeholder WhatsApp URL:

```
url: 'https://chat.whatsapp.com/YOUR_ACTUAL_INVITE_CODE',
```

9.2 LINE Group / Official Account

Option A: LINE Official Account (Recommended)

1. Go to manager.line.biz
2. Create an official account: `Bangkok Shambhala`
3. Customize: add profile photo, greeting message
4. Get the friend-add URL from Account settings
5. Update `src/lib/config.ts` with the LINE URL

Option B: LINE Group

1. Create a LINE group
2. Generate invite link via group settings
3. Update `src/lib/config.ts`

9.3 Facebook Page

1. Go to facebook.com/pages/create
2. Choose category: **Religious Organization** or **Non-Profit**
3. Page name: `Bangkok Shambhala`

4. Complete setup: add cover photo, about text, location
5. Note the page URL
6. Update `src/lib/config.ts` if different from current placeholder

9.4 Instagram

1. Create an Instagram account: `@shambhalabangkok`
2. Switch to **Professional/Business account** (Settings → Account)
3. Link to the Facebook page
4. Add website link in bio: `shambhala-bangkok.org`
5. Update `src/lib/config.ts` if needed

9.5 Meetup Group

1. Go to meetup.com/create
2. Create group: `Bangkok Shambhala`
3. Category: Spirituality → Meditation
4. Location: Bangkok
5. Add regular events to match your schedule
6. Update `src/lib/config.ts`

After Updating Config

After updating all URLs in `src/lib/config.ts` :

```
git add src/lib/config.ts
git commit -m "chore: update social channel URLs with real links"
git push
```

The site rebuilds automatically with the real links.

Verification

- ☐ WhatsApp group created, invite link works
- ☐ LINE group/account created, link works
- ☐ Facebook page created, URL updated

- ☐ Instagram account created, bio has website link
 - ☐ Meetup group created, events listed
 - ☐ All URLs updated in `src/lib/config.ts` and pushed
-

10. Wise (International Donations)

Purpose: Receive international donations with low transfer fees.

You need: A valid ID/passport, bank account.

Steps

1. Sign up at wise.com
2. Complete identity verification (ID + selfie)
3. Add your **bank account** as a recipient
4. Go to **Receive money** → **Get your account details**
5. Wise provides:
 - Account holder name
 - Account number / IBAN
 - Bank name/code (SWIFT/BIC)
6. **Create a payment link:**
 - Go to **Payment links** or **Request money**
 - Create a link for `Bangkok Shambhala Donation`
 - Choose: **any amount** (let supporters decide)
 - Copy the payment link
7. **Update** `src/lib/config.ts` — replace the Wise URL placeholder:

```
url: 'https://wise.com/pay/YOUR_ACTUAL_PAYMENT_LINK',
```

Verification

- ☐ Wise account verified
 - ☐ Payment link created and tested (send yourself a small amount)
 - ☐ URL updated in `config.ts` and pushed
-

11. PromptPay / Thai QR (Local Donations)

Purpose: Receive free instant donations from Thai bank accounts.

You need: A Thai bank account with PromptPay enabled.

Steps

1. **Enable PromptPay** on your Thai bank account:

- Open your banking app (SCB, KBank, Bangkok Bank, etc.)
- Go to Settings → PromptPay registration
- Register with your phone number or national ID

2. **Generate a QR code:**

- In your banking app → **Receive money** → **Show QR**
- Screenshot the QR code
- Alternative: Use the Bank of Thailand PromptPay standard QR generator

3. **Save the QR image:**

- Save as `public/images/promptpay-qr.png`
- Should be at least 400×400px

4. **Update the QR image path in the code** if the DonateWidget references a different path

5. **Note your PromptPay details** and update `src/lib/config.ts` :

- Account name
- PromptPay ID (phone number or ID for display)

Verification

- ☐ PromptPay registered on bank account
 - ☐ QR code image saved to `public/images/`
 - ☐ Test: scan with a different bank app (send 1 THB to yourself)
 - ☐ Donation page displays QR correctly
-

12. n8n (Automation Platform)

Purpose: Automated event notifications, weekly digests, broken link monitoring, social copy generation.

You need: An email address. Choose cloud or self-hosted.

Step 12.1 — Choose Deployment

Option	Cost	Best For
n8n.cloud	Free (5 workflows), then €20/mo	Quick setup, no server management
Self-hosted (Docker)	Free + VPS cost (~\$5/mo)	Full control, unlimited workflows

For n8n.cloud:

1. Sign up at n8n.cloud
2. Create an instance
3. Note your instance URL: `https://your-instance.app.n8n.cloud`

For self-hosted:

1. Provision a VPS (DigitalOcean, Hetzner, etc.)
2. Install Docker
3. Run:

```
docker run -d --name n8n -p 5678:5678 \
-v n8n_data:/home/node/.n8n \
n8nio/n8n
```

4. Access at `http://your-server:5678`
5. Set up HTTPS using a reverse proxy (Caddy or nginx)

Step 12.2 — Import Workflows

1. Open your n8n instance
2. Go to **Workflows** → **Import from file**
3. Import each workflow JSON:
 - `automation/n8n/event-published.json`
 - `automation/n8n/weekly-event-reminder.json`
 - `automation/n8n/broken-link-monitor.json`
 - `automation/n8n/social-copy-generator.json`

Step 12.3 — Configure Credentials

In n8n, go to **Settings** → **Variables** and add:

Variable	Value	Used By
<code>SITE_URL</code>	<code>https://shambhala-bangkok.org</code>	Weekly reminder, broken link monitor
<code>BREVO_API_KEY</code>	<i>(same as Vercel)</i>	Event published, weekly reminder, broken link
<code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code>	<i>(your admin email)</i>	Broken link monitor alerts

Step 12.4 — Configure Webhook Authentication

For the **Event Published** and **Social Copy Generator** webhooks:

1. Open each workflow
2. Click the **Webhook Trigger** node
3. Under Authentication → Header Auth:

- Header Name: `X-Webhook-Secret`
- Header Value: *(generate a random secret)*

4. Save the secret — you'll need it to call the webhook from CI/CD or scripts

Step 12.5 — Activate Workflows

1. Open each imported workflow
2. Toggle the **Active** switch in the top-right corner
3. Verify the cron triggers:
 - Weekly reminder: Monday at 09:00
 - Broken link monitor: Sunday at 03:00

Step 12.6 — Test Each Workflow

Event Published:

```
curl -X POST https://your-n8n.app.n8n.cloud/webhook/event-published \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "X-Webhook-Secret: your-secret" \
-d '{
  "title": "Test Event",
  "summary": "This is a test",
  "startDate": "2026-03-25T19:00:00+07:00",
  "canonicalUrl": "https://shambhala-bangkok.org/events/test",
  "socialCopyShort": "Join us for a test event!"
}'
```

Weekly Reminder: Click **Execute Workflow** manually in n8n.

Broken Link Monitor: Click **Execute Workflow** manually.

Verification

- ☐ n8n instance running (cloud or self-hosted)
- ☐ All 4 workflows imported
- ☐ Environment variables configured
- ☐ Webhook authentication set up
- ☐ All workflows activated

- ☐ Manual test execution succeeds for each workflow
-

13. OpenAI API (Social Copy AI)

Purpose: AI-generated social media copy for events (used by n8n social-copy-generator).

You need: A credit card for OpenAI billing.

Steps

1. Go to platform.openai.com
2. Sign up or log in
3. Go to **Settings** → **Billing** → add a payment method
4. Set a monthly spending limit (e.g., \$5 — enough for hundreds of generations)
5. Go to **API Keys** → **Create new secret key**
 - Name: `shambhala-n8n`
 - Copy the key immediately
6. **Add to n8n:**
 - Go to n8n → Settings → Variables
 - Add `OPENAI_API_KEY` = *(paste the key)*

Cost estimate: Each social copy generation uses ~500 tokens with `gpt-4o-mini`, costing approximately \$0.001. Even 100 events/month costs less than \$0.10.

Verification

- ☐ OpenAI account with billing enabled
 - ☐ API key generated and added to n8n
 - ☐ Test the Social Copy Generator workflow in n8n
-

14. Google Sheets (Social Copy Log)

Purpose: Store AI-generated social copy for editorial review before posting.

You need: A Google account.

Steps

1. Go to sheets.google.com → **Create new spreadsheet**
2. Name it: Bangkok Shambhala – Social Copy
3. Add column headers in Row 1:

A	B	C	D	E	F
Event Title	Event Date	Facebook	Instagram	WhatsApp	LINE

4. Note the **Spreadsheet ID** from the URL:

`https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/SPREADSHEET_ID_HERE/edit`

5. **Create a Service Account** for n8n access:

- Go to console.cloud.google.com
- Create a new project: shambhala-bangkok
- Enable the **Google Sheets API**
- Go to **Credentials** → **Create credentials** → **Service account**
- Name: n8n-sheets-writer
- Download the JSON key file
- In the spreadsheet, click **Share** → add the service account email as Editor

6. **Add to n8n:**

- Create a **Google Sheets** credential in n8n using the service account JSON
- Or add these as variables:
 - `GOOGLE_SHEET_ID` = (the spreadsheet ID)
 - `GOOGLE_ACCESS_TOKEN` = (service account token)

Verification

- ☐ Google Sheet created with correct columns

- ☐ Service account created with Sheets API access
 - ☐ Sheet shared with service account email
 - ☐ n8n can write to the sheet (test the Social Copy Generator)
-

15. Cloudinary (Image CDN) — Optional

Purpose: Host and optimize images externally (better performance than Git-stored images).

You need: An email address.

Steps

1. Sign up at cloudinary.com (free tier: 25 credits/month)
2. From the Dashboard, note:
 - **Cloud name**
 - **API key**
 - **API secret**
3. **Add to Vercel environment variables:**
 - `CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME` = *(cloud name)*
 - `CLOUDINARY_API_KEY` = *(API key)*
 - `CLOUDINARY_API_SECRET` = *(API secret)*
4. The `next.config.js` already allows Cloudinary images via the `remotePatterns` config
5. **Upload images** via Cloudinary's dashboard or API

Note: Cloudinary is optional. Images stored in `public/images/` or referenced by URL work fine for a site this size.

Verification

- ☐ Cloudinary account created

- ☐ Env vars added to Vercel
- ☐ Test: upload an image, use its URL in a blog post

Final: Environment Variables Summary

After completing all services, your Vercel environment should have:

Variable	Source	Required
NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL	Your domain	✓ Yes
NEXT_PUBLIC_PLAUSIBLE_DOMAIN	Plausible (Section 5)	✓ Yes
BREVO_API_KEY	Brevo (Section 4)	✓ Yes
BREVO_LIST_ID	Brevo (Section 4)	✓ Yes
ADMIN_EMAIL	Admin Panel (Section 6)	✓ Yes
ADMIN_PASSWORD	Admin Panel (Section 6)	✓ Yes
ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET	Admin Panel (Section 6)	✓ Yes
GITHUB_TOKEN	Admin Panel (Section 6)	✓ Yes
TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY	Cloudflare (Section 6)	Optional
TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY	Cloudflare (Section 6)	Optional
CLOUDINARY_CLOUD_NAME	Cloudinary (Section 15)	Optional
CLOUDINARY_API_KEY	Cloudinary (Section 15)	Optional
CLOUDINARY_API_SECRET	Cloudinary (Section 15)	Optional

And your **n8n instance** should have:

Variable	Source	Required
<code>SITE_URL</code>	Your domain	✓ Yes
<code>BREVO_API_KEY</code>	Brevo (Section 4)	✓ Yes
<code>ADMIN_EMAIL</code>	Your email	✓ Yes
<code>OPENAI_API_KEY</code>	OpenAI (Section 13)	Optional
<code>GOOGLE_SHEET_ID</code>	Google Sheets (Section 14)	Optional

Post-Setup Verification

Once all services are configured, run through this final checklist:

- ☐ Site loads at `https://shambhala-bangkok.org`
- ☐ Newsletter signup form works (check email appears in Brevo)
- ☐ Plausible shows real-time visitors
- ☐ Admin panel login works at `/admin/login`
- ☐ Create a test event in admin panel → appears on site after rebuild
- ☐ Calendar feed works at `/api/calendar/feed.ics`
- ☐ WhatsApp button opens the correct group
- ☐ LINE button opens the correct group
- ☐ Donation QR code is visible on `/donate`
- ☐ Wise payment link works
- ☐ Google Search Console shows sitemap submitted
- ☐ Google Business Profile is live
- ☐ n8n workflows are active and tested
- ☐ Security headers grade: test at securityheaders.com
- ☐ Performance: test at pagespeed.web.dev

Congratulations! 🎉 All services are configured and the Bangkok Shambhala website is fully operational.

